Global CO_2 Emissions: Trends, Regional Shifts, and Per Ca

Scope: 1750–2024 | Atmospheric context through Feb 2026

1750 1900 1950 1990 2024

Sources: NASA Vital Signs (CO_2) | Our World in Data — Global Carbon Budget 2025

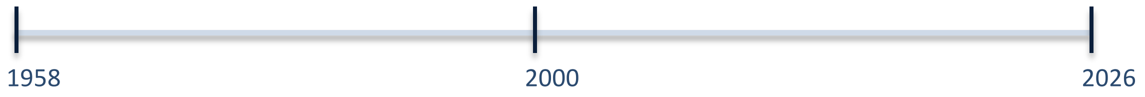
Atmospheric CO_2 Reaches 429 ppm — 50% Above Pre-Industrial Levels

Acceleration is confirmed by ground-based and satellite measurements.

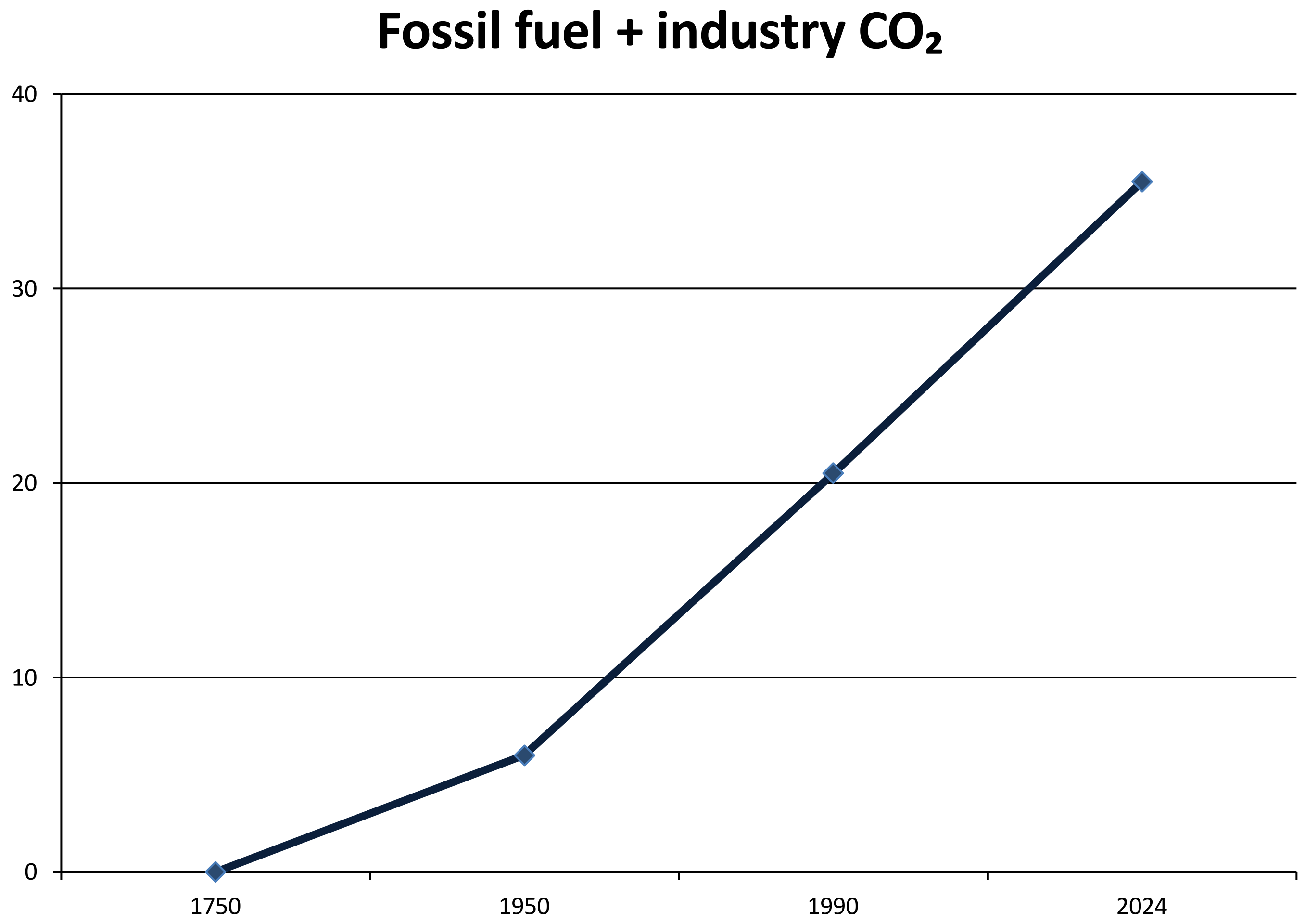
Primary driver: combustion of coal, oil, and natural gas.

Scale of change: comparable magnitude to natural post–ice age increase, but compressed into ~two centuries.

Keeling Curve era: rapid rise since 1958



Data: NOAA Mauna Loa (Feb 2026); context: NASA Vital Signs



Global Fossil Fuel CO_2 Emissions Grew Six-Fold: 6 Billion to 35+ Billion Tonnes

Figure reference: figure_2.jpg (per brief)

Source: Our World in Data — Global Carbon Budget 2025

China Now Emits Over 12 Billion Tonnes — More Than Double the United States

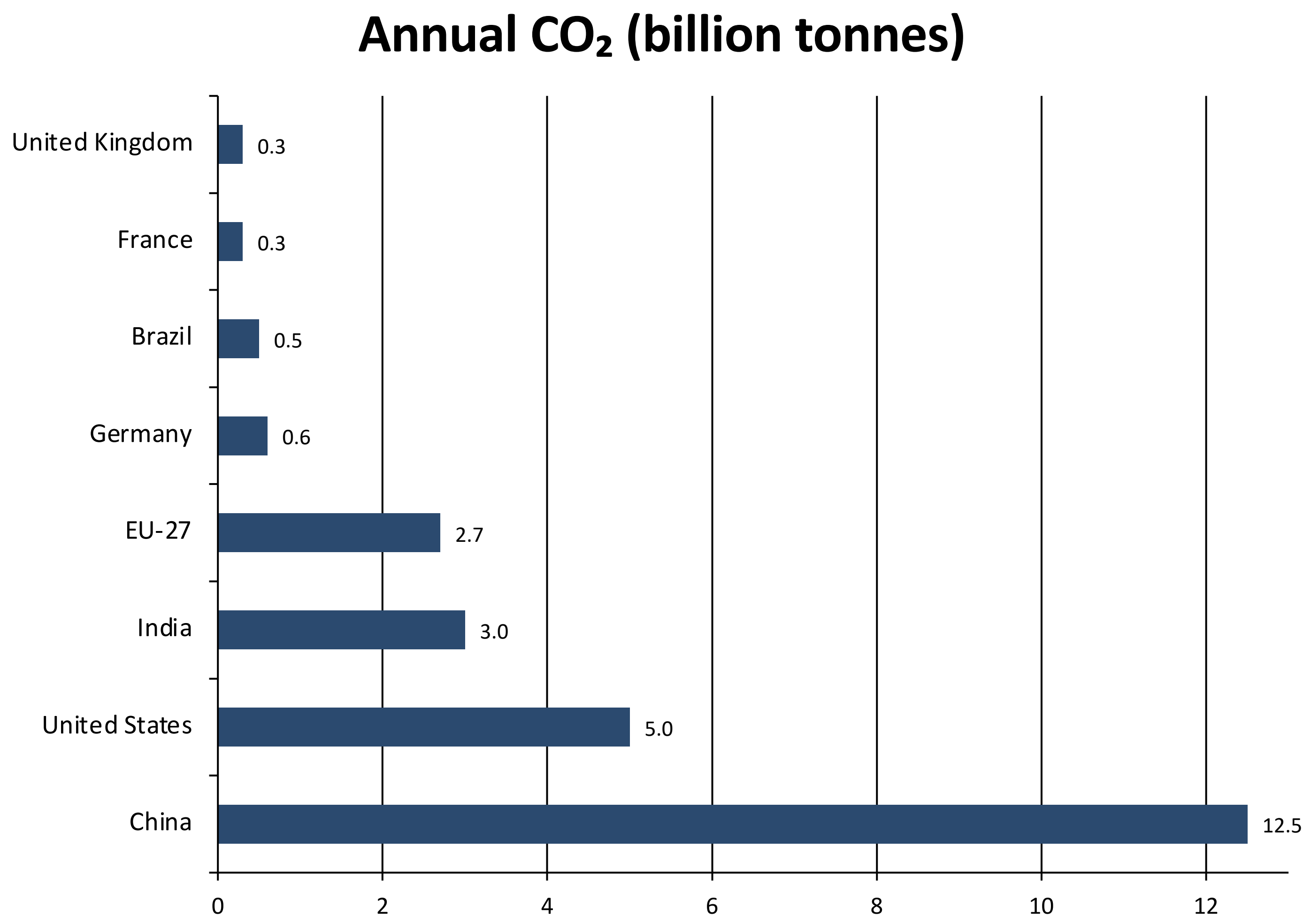
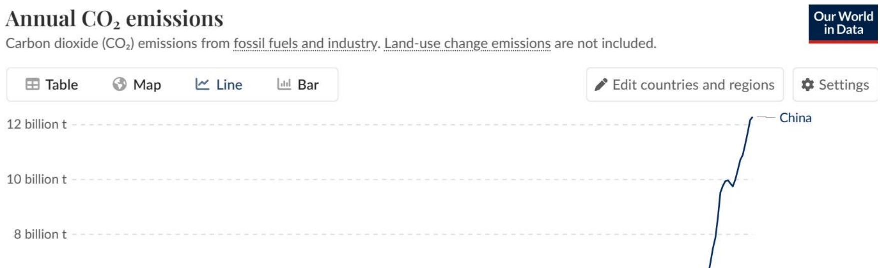
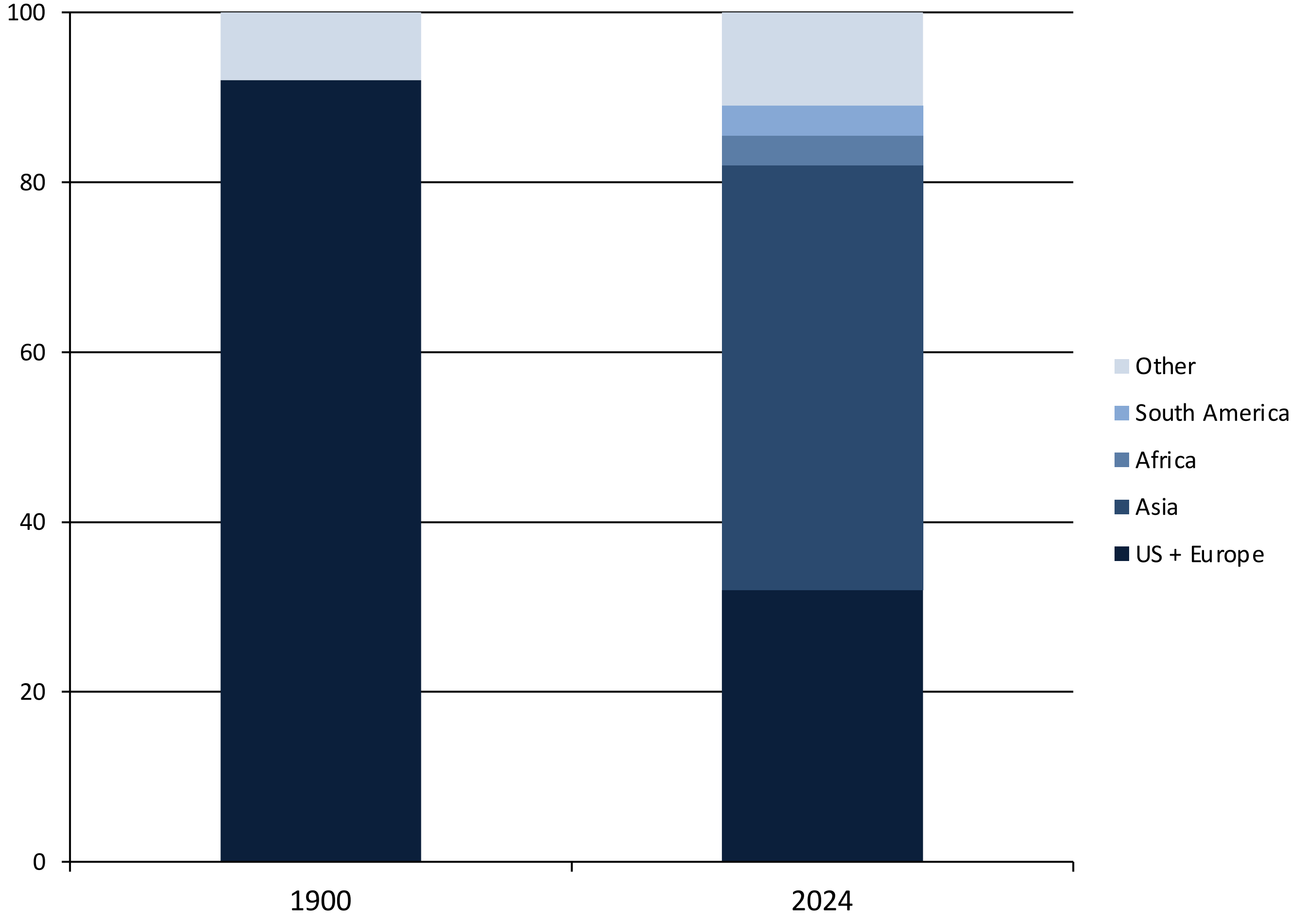


Figure: figure_3.jpg (Our World in Data — Global Carbon Budget 2025)



REGIONAL SHARES



Asia Now Accounts for ~50% of Global Emissions; US + Europe Below One-Third

Visual: stacked-area / comparison depiction (per brief).

Source: Our World in Data — Global Carbon Budget 2025

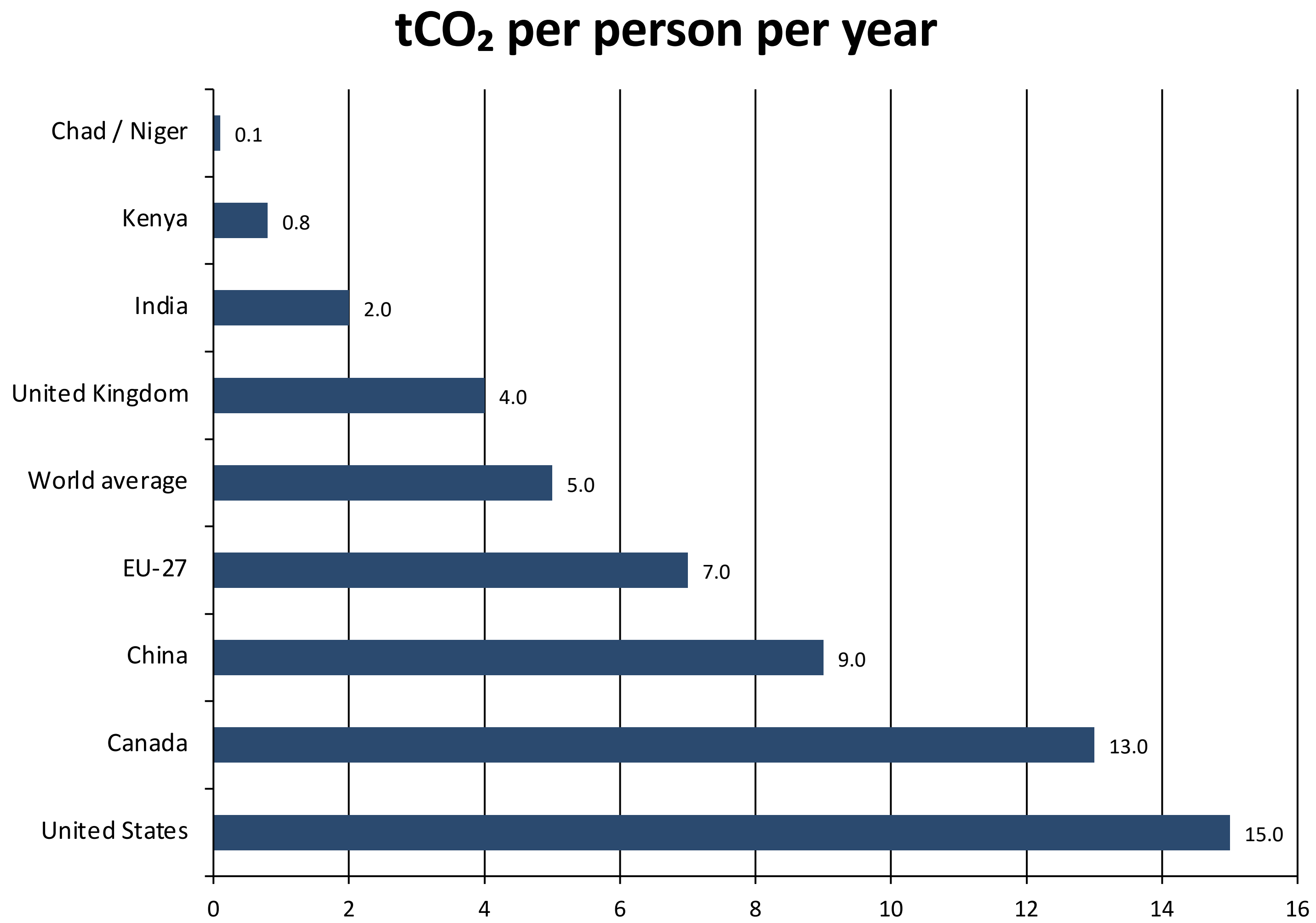
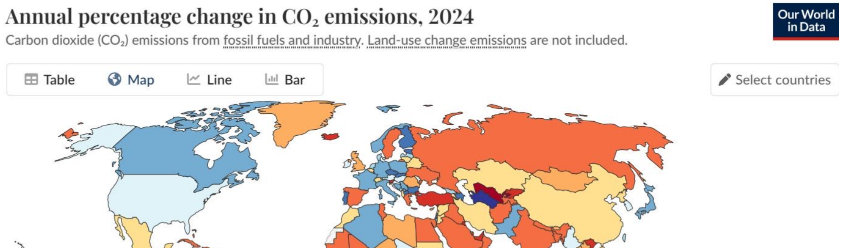


Figure: figure_1.jpg (Our World in Data — Global Carbon Budget 2025)

Per Capita Gap: 15 t in the US vs. 0.1 t in Chad — a 150× Disparity

Among large economies, US and Canada are ~3× the world average.

Low emitters remain <1 t/person (Kenya) and ~0.1 t/person (Chad/Niger).



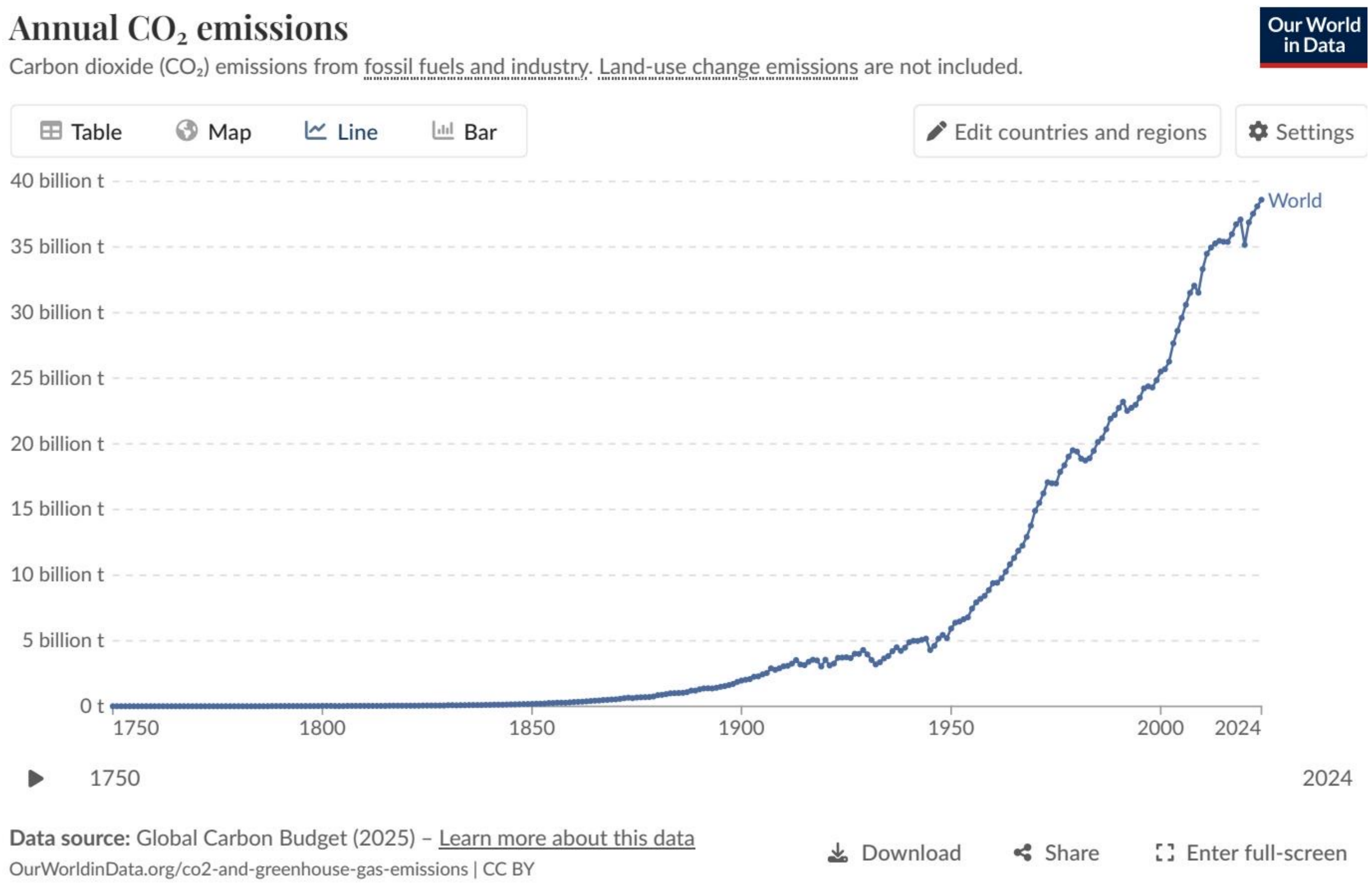


Figure: figure_4.jpg (Our World in Data — Global Carbon Budget 2025)

2024 Snapshot: US and Europe Cut Emissions While Russia and SE Asia Increase

Energy Mix Explains Why France Emits Far Less Per Capita Than Germany

Group	Energy mix (high-level)	Per-capita CO_2 signal	Example countries
Lower-carbon power mix	Higher nuclear + renewables	Lower per capita (~4 t/person)	France, UK
More fossil-heavy mix	Higher fossil fuel share	Higher per capita	Germany, Netherlands

Source: Our World in Data — Global Carbon Budget 2025 (qualitative energy-mix note in brief)

Key Takeaways: Emissions Are Still Rising, But the Map of Responsibility Is Shifting

Sources: NASA Vital Signs (CO_2) | Our World in Data — Global Carbon Budget 2025